17 September 2025

[redacted]

Committee Secretariat
Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters
PO Box 6021
Parliament House
CANBERRA ACT 2600

Dear Committee Secretary

Re: JCSEM into the conduct of the 2025 Federal Election

I am writing to make a formal submission into the JSCEM inquiry into the 2025 Federal Election.

I live in the electorate of Bennelong and have done so since 1994. During that time, I have volunteered on most elections. Particularly on election day for the political party of my choice.

My experience this past election has been like no other.

I read in the papers that many volunteers for the Liberal Party at this election were members of the Plymouth Brethren. This surprised me as it is my understanding that the Brethren discourage their members from voting.

The newspapers reported that Brethren members had scripts about how to respond if asked about their activities. And when I spoke to their volunteers they responded exactly on script confirming to my mind that these ere Brthren members.

It was obvious to me that the Brethren's participation at this election was a well organised and precision like operation.

Since the election I have seen numerous media reports about the Brethren with suggestions that their activities and efforts in the political arena are something new. However, this is untrue.

In 2004 in Bennelong there was a strong community campaign centred around then then local member and Prime Minister, John Howard. This campaign was known as "Not Happy John". The Brethren who have locations within Bennelong were strong supporters/defenders of Mr Howard.

So much so that the ran newspaper adverts in the local newspaper, The Weekly Times (TWT), supporting Mr Howard. For your reference have enclosed a copy of the advert they ran in the October 6 edition of the TWT which I found tucked away in my collection of election memorabilia.

I am surprised that a religious/charity organisation so actively involved itself in an election campaign in 2025. And as the enclosed advert illustrates, the have been doing so since 2004.

These are not the actions of individuals randomly and separately deciding to volunteer for a candidate or party.

This is a well organised and I suspect well-funded coordinated participation aimed at affecting the outcome of a federal election.

I believe that the conduct and financial involvement of the Brethren in the 2025 Federal election is worth of investigation by the Joint Standing Committee on Electoral matters.

If you wish to seek any clarification or further information, I can be contacted at my home address or via email: [redacted] or [redacted].

Yours sincerely

[redacted]

MICHAEL BUTTERWORTH

Advertisement

Keep Bennelong in Safe Hands
Keep Australia in Safe Hands
Keep HOWARD in Bennelong

What John Howard Promises
He Delivers

- ✓ Lower Interest Rates
- ✓ Lower Unemployment
- ✓ Lower Inflation
- ✓ Proven Track Record
- ✓ Support for Families
- ✓ Greater National Security
- ✓ Increased Choice of Education
- ✓ Increased Medicare Benefits
- ✓ Environmental Protection
- ✓ Improved Water Resources
- ✓ Improved Industrial Relations
- ✓ Support for Small Business

Australia has never had it better
Don't risk a wrecked economy

JOHN HOWARD - 8½ Years Prime Minister
and 30 Years in Parliament

LABOR IN BENNELONG – *NO EXPERIENCE*
GREENS IN BENNELONG – *NO EXPERIENCE*

Who is the *liar* in Bennelong? NOT John Howard!

We *are* happy John!

Authorised by S Hales – MET School 32 See St Meadowbank